



Revolutionary poster

Urging peasants to unite under the name of Zapata, the commander of the Liberation Army of the South, this poster says, "The land should belong to those who work it." Large landed estates were forcing peasants from the land.

Plundered resources

Coffee was a nonnative crop introduced by the Europeans. Before 1800 it was mainly produced by slaves on plantations controlled by colonists.



Hidalgo appealed to the indigenous Mexicans to eject from the village of Dolores the wealthy classes of Spanish descent. This became known as the *Grito de Dolores* ("Cry of Dolores"). Hidalgo's untrained army grew to number 80,000 as it conquered towns and larger cities, and threatened Mexico City itself. After a dramatic defeat, Hidalgo was captured in 1811 and executed. But by then Mexican independence was on its way to being realized, and was achieved in 1822.

Brazilian independence

In Brazil, the discovery of a conspiracy against Portuguese rule in 1789–98 showed that some groups there had

already been contemplating the idea of independence in the late 18th century. The reliance of the Brazilian upper classes on African slavery, (see pp.280–81) however, favored their continued ties to Portugal. The key step in the relatively bloodless end of colonial rule was the flight of the Portuguese court from Lisbon to Rio de Janeiro in 1808, to escape Napoleon's

invading troops. After 13 years, King John returned to Portugal, leaving his son Pedro as regent. Dom Pedro I proclaimed Brazil independent in 1822, with himself as emperor. In 1831, however, he abdicated, leaving his five-year-old son, Dom Pedro II, as regent, until 1840, when he was made emperor. He reigned until 1889, when he was deposed, and a republic was proclaimed.

Building new nations

The former Spanish America split into more than a dozen separate countries. Adapting models from northern

Europe and the US, republics were set up across the region.

The earliest were in Venezuela, Chile, and New Granada in 1811–12.

Factional fighting caused the first constitutional governments to fail, however, and the unrest led to more centralized regimes by the mid-19th century. Governments changed rapidly in most regions, and the use of force became common. Military men, "caudillos," rose to positions of dominance and consolidated their power through strategic alliances.

In many countries, difficult financial circumstances contributed to political instability. But by the 1860s and 1870s, manufacturers from England, the US, and other nations were welcomed, and there was a surge in demand for sugar, coffee, wheat, and beef. Traditional exports such as silver recovered, and exceeded previous production levels.

SOUTH AMERICAN REVOLUTIONARY LEADER (1783–1830)

SIMON BOLIVAR

Simón Bolívar was a South American patriot, and hero of the struggle for independence from Spain. Born an aristocrat, Bolívar began his revolutionary career in Venezuela in 1813, after visits to Europe and the US, where he had absorbed anticolonial ideas. He was called "El Libertador" ("The Liberator"). Bolívar spent his remaining years unsuccessfully trying to forge a union of the newly independent states.

"... experience comes from bad judgment."

SIMON BOLIVAR, ATTRIBUTED



When domestic funding was scarce, European investment helped to provide money for improved infrastructure. Foreign firms, from countries such as

JUNTA A Spanish word for a governing group, often used to refer to military officers who seize power and establish an authoritarian government.

Britain, constructed railways, streetcar systems, and electricity networks. Latin America underwent a thorough integration into the world economy. While urban populations flourished, however, rural life remained poor.

The Mexican Revolution

In 1876 General Porfirio Díaz forcibly seized power in Mexico and set up a dictatorship. He opened up the country to foreign investment and allowed the owners of foreign estates to take more of the Indian peasants' lands. Resentment of these policies exploded in the revolution of 1910. Díaz was overthrown in 1911, but fighting broke out between rival factions. Díaz's successor, Francisco Madero, failed to carry out promised agrarian reforms and was overthrown in 1913. President Álvaro Obregón (1920–24) finally implemented them and fighting ceased.

AFTER

After centuries of colonial rule, industrialization and democracy came to Latin America only slowly.

NEW CONSTITUTION FOR MEXICO

In 1917, President Venustiano Carranza began to create the **modern Mexican state** with **land reforms** and more limits on the Church's power.



CARRANZA

NEW INDUSTRY

Shortages of goods caused by the two World Wars were an **incentive to industrialization**. The Great Depression of the 1930s **384–85** >>, however, hit Latin America hard. Heavy industry was not established until the 1950s. Brazil, Mexico, and Argentina became Latin America's leading producers of iron, steel, and machinery.

THE DAWN OF MASS POLITICS

Latin America has often been politically unstable. Many countries have swung between **extremes of left and right**, but most countries are now democracies **422–23, 438–39** >>.

1816 Argentina declares independence. José de San Martín assembles an army for his long-term campaign for Peru.

1813 Morelos summons a congress in Chilpancingo. In November the congress declares Mexican independence.

1810 Miguel Hidalgo y Costilla leads a movement in Mexico, starting the War of Independence against Spain.

1811 Venezuela and Paraguay declare independence from Spain. Hidalgo is killed and replaced by José María Morelos in Mexico.

1822 Dom Pedro I declares Brazil independent from Portugal and becomes emperor, until his abdication in 1831. His son, Dom Pedro II, takes control in 1840.

1824 Last patriot victories against the Spaniards. Peru gains independence.

1825 Bolivia declares independence, taking its name from "The Liberator" Simón Bolívar.

1830 Gran Colombia splits into the separate countries of Colombia, Venezuela, and Ecuador.

1876 General Porfirio Díaz established as dictator of Mexico.

1898 Spanish-Cuban-American War. Cuba gains independence from Spain.

1888 Princess Isabel abolishes slavery in Brazil.

1889 Dom Pedro II of Brazil is deposed. Two years later, a republican constitution is instituted.

TRANSFORMING LATIN AMERICA

The 19th century saw major upheaval throughout Latin America, beginning with nationalist revolts, and culminating in the Brazilian republic and the Mexican Revolution.

1910–20 Mexican Revolution leads to the toppling of Díaz in 1911. Peace is achieved under President Álvaro Obregón.